Vasilen Kanchev

Data Engineer

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WORK EXPERIENCE

Data Engineer | Gosian Media LLC
South Carolina | June 2025 - Present

- Built a PostgreSQL database on AWS RDS, migrating 30+ legacy spreadsheets into a normalized relational schema.
- Developed containerized Python scripts using Docker to extract data from REST APIs and web sources, automating ETL ingestion and improving consistency of data supplied to the product team.
- Implemented dbt-based ETL workflows for recurring transformations, with automated validation tests that catch data anomalies before downstream analysis and modeling.
- Engineered automated Python pipelines to replace legacy data collection, eliminating 10+ hours of manual data entry per week.

Data Analyst | Influencer Marketing Hub
United Kingdom | November 2023 - June 2025

- Analysed influencer engagement, audience demographics and campaign performance datasets to support marketing strategy and campaign decisions.
- Automated daily and weekly KPI reporting with Python and Tableau, eliminating manual aggregation and scaling reporting visibility for 15+ stakeholders.
- Developed ETL workflows to extract, clean and standardise data from social media APIs for analysis and reporting.
- Helped design campaign A/B tests, assess statistical significance, and present findings to senior stakeholders.

Data Administrator / Operations Analyst | TapIn Platforms, Inc.
Miami, Florida | October 2021 - November 2023

- Managed relational databases, performing daily validation and record updates to support accurate operational data.
- Used advanced Excel and SQL to identify business trends, track user growth and report on operational metrics.
- Identified inefficiencies in raw data collection and proposed software solutions that centralized the company's internal knowledge base.
- Supported product and marketing teams with ad hoc data requests and SQL queries to extract specific user cohorts.

Operations & Data Assistant | CoEfficient & NPC
Johannesburg, South Africa | July 2019 - September 2021

- Digitized legacy business records and validated daily operational data across CRM, inventory and financial systems.
- Supported data integration and market analysis for Inea Consulting and Renewable Market Watch outlook reports.
- Executed monthly data reconciliations to investigate discrepancies and ensure accurate end-of-month reporting.

Professional Coach and Player | Valorant Friends League & Community
Deggendorf, Germany | March 2020 - June 2025

- Reached the #1 global VALORANT ranking, substituted for a Tier 1 organisation, and won multiple international LAN tournaments across Europe.

PROJECTS

Wikipedia Streaming Lakehouse | Kafka, Spark Structured Streaming, DuckDB, Terraform
Wikipedia edits through Kafka and Spark into Parquet, late and malformed events handled, tested on real Kafka in CI. Terraform validated, not deployed. github.com/VasilenData/wiki-stream-lakehouse

HN Pulse: Live Data Pipeline | Python, dbt, Airflow, DuckDB, GitHub Actions
Hacker News API through dbt models (27 data tests, enforced contracts) into DuckDB, with a freshness gate; failing tests block the live dashboard update. vasilendata.github.io/hn-pulse/

Four-Engine Benchmark on 79M Rows | DuckDB, Polars, pandas, Spark
Same four queries on 79 million NYC taxi trips with cross-checked answers: DuckDB 1.4 s against 32.8 s for pandas. github.com/VasilenData/taxi-engines-benchmark

Retrieval Evaluation for RAG | Qdrant, BM25, fastembed
BM25, vector search, rank fusion and reranking on 2,000 labelled questions; recall@1 76% to 86% with reranking. Retrieval only. github.com/VasilenData/rag-retrieval-eval

Tech Job Market ETL Pipeline | Python, PostgreSQL, GitHub Actions
Daily pipeline pulling hiring data from public APIs into a normalized PostgreSQL schema with idempotent upserts, validation, 6 tests and lint in CI (875 postings loaded, zero duplicates on re-run). github.com/VasilenData/tech-job-market-etl

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Python, SQL (PostgreSQL), Bash, AWS RDS, Docker, dbt, Apache Airflow, DuckDB, Kafka, Spark, Polars, Terraform, GitHub Actions, Tableau, Pandas, Scikit-Learn

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

University of Suffolk | BSc (Hons) Computer Science | Expected 2027
UNISA | Mathematics and Statistics Higher Certificate (Distinction) | 2024
Certifications: Google Data Analytics Professional Certificate; IBM Data Engineering Certificate